

64.22 while striking at over 106.

Add to that the fact that, barring five T20Is in 2021, he had never played in the top order for New Zealand.

How did the 24-year-old manage to make Indian conditions his own?

"I guess that's the thing with cricket and sport in general — things can happen quickly," Ravindra said.

It helped that he played plenty of cricket during his teenage years in India, practising with his former Wellington and New Zealand A coach, Sriram Krishnamurthy, who is now with CSK academy.

"I think through my teenage years, and you play on pitches that aren't quite as good as what these ones have been out here. So, you learn a few skills and adapt, which is quite important," Ravindra said during a media interaction.

"Working with Sri has been great. I've known him since I was 15. Just about learning about different things, and he's good at having a hard word every now and again. He can tell me when something's not right. I think it helps having the familiarity around it being in India and having played a lot of cricket here," he added.

After an impressive show in the World Cup in October and November, it was only a matter of time before an IPL franchise would pick him in the auction held in December. It turned out to be CSK, which got him for Rs. 1.8 crore, although as a backup opener to compatriot Devon Conway.

As things turned out, Conway, who scored 672 runs in IPL 2023, got injured before the current season began, opening up an opportunity for Ravindra to face the new ball.

"It's sort of big shoes to fill. If I can do half (of) what he does, it'll be really good for the team," he added.

The CSK management hasn't given him any specific instructions on how to go about things, and the "chill" environment in the team has helped him be himself.

"They talk about strike rates and all that stuff. Role clarity comes from playing your game, and that's



Rachin Ravindra shone against spin in the ODI World Cup with an average of 141 and a strike rate nearing 118.